



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

śrī-bhagavān uvāca

*abhayaṃ sattva-saṃsuddhir jñāna-yoga-vyavasthitiḥ |
dānaṃ damaś ca yajñaś ca svādhyāyas tapa ājavam || 1 ||*

— *Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse*

1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The divine voice, Sri Bhagavan, begins by outlining the qualities that lead to liberation, to the ultimate realization of the Self. Fearlessness, the absence of terror, is paramount. It's not just physical courage, but the inner strength that comes from knowing your true nature is indestructible. Cultivating purity of being, sattva-samsuddhi, is equally vital. This involves cleansing your mind and heart of negativity, of ego-driven desires and attachments that cloud your judgment.

He continues by highlighting steadfastness in the yoga of knowledge, jnana-yoga-vyavasthiti. This means a persistent and unwavering commitment to understanding the nature of reality through wisdom and contemplation. This isn't a fleeting interest, but a deep and consistent practice of self-inquiry.

Then comes the call to selfless action: giving, dānaṃ; self-control, damaś; and sacrifice, yajñaś. These are not mere rituals, but acts of offering your time, resources, and ego for the benefit of others. It also includes regular self-study, svādhyāyas; austerity, tapa; and straightforwardness, ājavam. Austerity speaks to disciplined effort, not necessarily deprivation, but a focused channeling of energy. Straightforwardness is about honesty and integrity in your dealings with yourself and the world.

In modern life, these qualities are more relevant than ever. Fearlessness allows you to navigate challenges with grace. Purity of being helps you make ethical choices in a complex world. Steadfastness in knowledge allows you to discern truth from falsehood in an age of information overload. Selfless action connects you to something larger than yourself, fostering purpose and meaning. Cultivating these virtues is a lifelong journey, a continuous refinement of your character that leads to inner peace and a deeper understanding of your place in the universe. Embrace these qualities, and you will find yourself living a life of purpose, meaning, and joy.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you consciously cultivate just one of these qualities – fearlessness, purity, knowledge, giving, self-control, sacrifice, self-study, austerity, or straightforwardness – in your daily life today, and what small step can you take to begin?